Monday Nite Footballers Predictions

By Jim "Grand Dad" Nunnelly

PRE-SEASON HOME OPENER SUNDAY

The Tennessee Titans, the renamed and relocated Houston Oilers, will visit Arrowhead stadium this Sunday evening to help the Chiefs celebrate their pre-season opener. Look for a near sell-out, but don't look for anything too revealing. Starters or veterans will play a quarter or so and then defer to the rookies, free agents, and also-rans. But do lookout for Warren Moon, arguably the best backup quarterback in the NFL. Moon will play a lot, mainly to get acquainted with the Chiefs "Midwest Coast Offense." Moon, who has filled the air with rifle-like passes for many years, was chosen to become second fiddle to shaky Elvis Grbac. Knowing the 41-year-old veteran, he will add some sparks to an offense in need of something.

SIGNIFICANT POTPOURRI

During all the hoopla surrounding Denver's second consecutive Super Bowl victory, little attention was given to the losing team, the Atlanta Falcons,and its classy running back, Jamil Anderson. Last year, Anderson carried the ball a record 410 times, making him the busiest back in the entire NFL. That and his 1,800-plus yards earned him a five-year contract worth a cool $32 million...You will remember Brianna Scurry, game-saving goalie of the world champion U.S. Soccer team. She and her teammates will have their individual pictures featured on the Wheaties breakfast cereal box. Though not the first time for an African American female, it will be the first time for soccer players to be so honored.

A TRIVIA QUESTION

What do the San Diego Chargers, the Denver Broncos, and the Pittsburgh Steelers have in common? ANSWER: They are all on the Chiefs' 1999 regular season schedule and each has been to the Super Bowl in the last five years. Denver winning twice and Pittsburgh and San Diego losing to Dallas and San Francisco, respectively.

'A WORD FROM GRAND DAD' ON GENERATION RAP

The word tomorrow will be "clandestine." Current events make us consider the power and application of this word. All of us know about the shootings in Atlanta and this week's hate assault on the Jewish Community center. We'll discuss how underground, secretive people emerge in the headlines. It's all on Carl Boyd's "Generation Rap" at 8 a.m. Saturday on the HOT 103 KPRS-FM.

GLOSSARY OF FOOTBALL TERMINOLOGY

As the high school, college and professional football seasons start, there will be terms being used that may be unfamiliar to you. While the list is not exhaustive, it does include some you will hear used by commentators and officials. We, Monday Niters, want to start you off with the right stuff:

AUDIBLE -- This is a change of play, shouted out by the quarterback at the line of scrimmage. Do not confuse this with the usual calling of the signals.

BLITZ -- This is a pass rush conducted by the defensive backfield. Since the line usually rushes, it is considered an expected surprise.

RED ZONE -- The area inside the 20-yard line. In short, if the offense moves the ball to the red zone, they are expected to score a touchdown.

SACK -- When the quarterback is tackled behind the line of scrimmage, while attempting to pass.

SHOTGUN -- An offensive formation where the quarterback lines up five to seven yards behind the line of scrimmage, usually to pass.

If you have a question about the Chiefs, football in general, or drug problems, call Jim Nunnelly at 881-3814 and leave a message.

COMBAT KUDOS

Tracey Blaylock and Angela Castle deserve congratulations for their efforts in kicking off "Drug Awareness Month" at the Pioneer College campus at 18th and Prospect this past Saturday. Ms. Blaylock is a manager at the Mid-America Addiction Technology Transfer Center and Ms. Castle is employed by Jackson County Prosecutor Bob Beaird.

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